Kuku — AI microdrama

pack: "I Married a Broken Soldier. He was a Duke" · 50 ep · ~2 min each · 1431 dialogue lines (+114 SFX rows)

Making

→ script gen (per episode)
→ TTS voice per speaker label
→ video gen → publish

visual desc drift? Juliana "blue eyes" 10/10 ✓
consistent ~~problem~~

Promoting

~~Promo finder = P1~~ → already their problem

Adapting

→ dub into N languages
→ voice cast per character per language

dub line-fit? median 2.5 w/s, p90 3.9 w/s → room to breathe ~~not it~~

Speaker labels ≠ characters

65 labels ↑ for ≈45 speaking roles
8 leads carry 20 labels

~~P2 AI lawyer~~ → not Kuku's work

Pick: cast / speaker-label drift — one person · one step · one output you can check

who: dubbing / voice-cast editor (and whoever prompts ep N+1). how I know: pack numbers above + kukufm.com lists 7 languages (Hi, En, Mr, Bn, Te, Ta, Ml) → N = 7. still owed: viewer / review check → empty slot (Play Store blocked fetch)

As-is flow

Prompt + prev-ep continuity notes

↓

Script ep N (labels = what camera knows now)

↓

TTS: 1 voice per label ← who is this?

↓

Video gen

↓

Dub × N languages (cast again, per language)

↓

Publish

one bad label fans out

1 label × 7 languages (kukufm.com) × every episode it recurs in

LADY JULIANA → **104** lines, ep 1-3 **and back in 21-24, 34**
THE FORMER GROOM → ep 1-3, **back in ep 9** after GERALD named ep 4
BLOND NOBLEMAN → **46** lines ep 2→ 44, = Rupert (parenthetical says so), RUPERT label exists from ep 20
LORD ep 33 → **36** lines, never named anywhere

today: fixed by hand, per show, per language — or not fixed (voice swaps mid-series)

Hypotheses (can't see Kuku's pipeline → all are guesses to test)

H1 — label = camera knowledge, not identity. Ep 1-3 "LADY IN GOLD GOWN", "THE FORMER GROOM" are deliberate pre-reveal descriptors. Bug is they're never back-filled: the descriptor comes back after the name is known (LADY JULIANA ep 21+, FORMER GROOM ep 9).

H2 — honorific style never normalised. JULIANA / LADY JULIANA, CATHERINE / LADY CATHERINE, CLARISSA / LADY CLARISSA. Same person, 2 voices.

H3 — unnamed role never promoted when plot names them. BLOND NOBLEMAN (Rupert) stays a descriptor for 40 episodes. MYSTERIOUS BEARDED MAN / THE BEARDED STRANGER / SCARRED BEARDED MAN → ALEXANDER (ep 8).

H4 — generation sees only the previous episode's continuity notes, no cast bible. So drift accumulates: DOWAGER DUCHESS (ep 26-28, 43) vs ALEXANDER'S MOTHER (ep 35-36, 42) — same woman? plausibly yes, no file says so.

H5 — no check between script labels and TTS/dub cast list. Nothing fails loudly; it ships.

H6 — file format drifts too. Ep 6 writes SCENE END in caps; a simple parser reads 0 scenes and moves on. Silent.

ruled out: dub pacing (p90 3.9 w/s), visual description drift (eye colour stable), promo finding (P1).

RCA results

→ No cast bible across episodes → each episode re-decides who is who

→ Label follows the camera (pre-reveal descriptor) and is never back-filled

→ Honorifics (LADY X vs X) not normalised → 2 voices for 1 person

→ Unnamed role never promoted once the plot names them (Rupert, Alexander)

→ No gate between script label set and TTS / dub cast → ships silently

→ Format drift (ep 6) → parsers drop an episode without error

net: 65 labels → ≈45 people leads: 8 people, 20 labels, ~74% of all lines

person	labels seen	eps
Juliana	JULIANA · LADY JULIANA	1–3, 21–24, 34 as LADY
Alexander	ALEXANDER · MYSTERIOUS BEARDED MAN · THE BEARDED STRANGER · SCARRED BEARDED MAN	3–7 descriptors, named ep 8
Gerald	GERALD · THE FORMER GROOM	1–3, 9 as FORMER GROOM
Clarissa	CLARISSA · LADY CLARISSA · LADY IN GOLD GOWN	1–3, 4–13, 37
Catherine	CATHERINE · LADY CATHERINE	20–50, 27 as LADY
Stepmother	MATRIARCH · NOBLE MATRIARCH · LADY ASHCROFT	1, 3, 4–5
Alexander's mother	DOWAGER DUCHESS · ALEXANDER'S MOTHER	26–28, 43 / 35–36, 42 — **needs human ok**
Rupert	RUPERT · BLOND NOBLEMAN	2–44 / 20+
?	LORD (ep 33)	**unresolvable → flag, don't merge**

Solution — smallest thing: cast resolver

scripts folder (any show)

↓

code: parse labels · count lines · first/last ep · parentheticals "(Rupert)" · who-speaks-to-whom · tolerate caps / format drift

↓

AI: cluster aliases using CAMERA/ACTION context lines → canonical name + confidence + 1-line evidence

↓

human: review merges < 0.8 · unresolvable (LORD ep 33) stays flagged

↓

out: cast.json (id, aliases, eps, lines) · per-ep alias map · flags.csv

why this shape

→ counting is code (free, exact)
→ only the "is X the same as Y" question goes to the model → ~65 labels × 1 call per show, not 1431 lines
→ model swappable: one function, prompt + JSON schema

check it worked

→ labels per lead character → 1
→ spot-check 10 merges vs script
→ dub editor: minutes to build cast per show ↓
→ voice swaps mid-series after release → 0

where it fails

→ twins / disguise plots (same person, 2 identities on purpose)
→ unnamed roles with no context (LORD)
→ minor roles with 1 line → low confidence by design

Understanding the Scenario

Kuku ships AI-generated microdramas (1-2 min episodes, 50+ per show) and adapts them into many languages. Every speaker label in a script becomes a voice assignment: once for the original TTS, then once per dub language. The input pack (one show, 50 episodes) has 65 distinct speaker labels but roughly 45 speaking roles. The 8 lead characters alone are spelled 20 different ways.

Understanding the Problem

- **Who has it:** the dubbing / voice-cast editor who builds a cast list per show per language, and whoever prompts episode N+1 with no cast bible.
- **Deliberate vs accidental:** pre-reveal descriptors in ep 1-3 (THE FORMER GROOM, LADY IN GOLD GOWN) are intentional. The drift is that they come back after the name is known: LADY JULIANA in ep 21-24 and 34, THE FORMER GROOM in ep 9, BLOND NOBLEMAN (Rupert) for 46 lines up to ep 44.
- **Unresolvable cases exist:** LORD in ep 33 speaks 36 lines and is never named. A tool must flag this, not guess.
- **Format drift:** ep 6 uses a different casing for scene markers; a naive parser silently reads 0 scenes.
- **Why it beats P1 and P2:** P1's promo tool is downstream of this (a promo needs stable names to make sense on its own); P2 is outside Kuku's work. This one blocks every dub of every show and is fixable in one step.

Understanding the Process

- **Measure from the pack:** parse all 50 scripts, count labels, lines, first/last episode per label, co-occurrence.
- **Separate intent from drift:** a descriptor that recurs after the real name appears is drift; one that only precedes it is a reveal.
- **Hypothesise causes** (cannot see the pipeline): no cast bible, label follows camera knowledge, honorifics unnormalised, no gate before TTS/dub.
- **Build the smallest helper, run it on the pack, publish raw outputs, list failures.**

Introducing the Solution: Cast Resolver

Input

A folder of screenplays in the pack format (model-agnostic; works on any show).

Code (deterministic)

- Extract speaker labels, line counts, episodes, parenthetical hints such as `BLOND NOBLEMAN (Rupert ...)`, and the CAMERA/ACTION sentences around each label.
- Case-insensitive scene markers so ep 6 style files do not vanish.

AI (one call per show)

- Given the 65 labels with their context snippets, return clusters: canonical name, aliases, confidence, one line of evidence. JSON schema enforced. Model behind one function so a stronger API can be swapped in.

Human in the loop

- Merges under 0.8 confidence go to a review list. Labels with no naming evidence (LORD ep 33) are flagged, never merged.

Output

- `cast.json`: one row per character with aliases, episodes, line count.
- `alias_map.csv`: episode, raw label, canonical id.
- `flags.csv`: what a human must decide.

How we would know it worked

Metric	Now (pack)	Target
Labels per lead character	2.5 (20 labels / 8 leads)	1
Unresolved labels surfaced to a human	0 (nothing surfaces today)	all of them, with evidence
Editor time to build a show cast list	manual read of 50 scripts	review of one flags list
Voice swaps for one character after release	unknown, assumed > 0	0

Where it fails

- Plots where one person deliberately has two identities (disguise, twin): the resolver will want to merge them.
- Unnamed roles with thin context: correct behaviour is a flag, which still costs human time.
- One-line extras: low confidence by design, so the review list grows with cast size.

- If scripts stop carrying CAMERA/ACTION descriptions, the model loses most of its evidence.

Operational Realities and Assumptions

- Assumed: speaker labels drive voice assignment in Kuku's TTS and dub steps. If casting is already keyed on a bible, the problem moves to the writer's side, same tool.
- Assumed: DOWAGER DUCHESS and ALEXANDER'S MOTHER are the same person. Nothing in the pack states it; this is exactly the kind of merge the human must confirm.
- External check so far: kukufm.com lists seven content languages (Hindi, English, Marathi, Bengali, Telugu, Tamil, Malayalam), which sets the fan-out at 7 per label. The site shows no Kuku TV or microdrama page and the Play Store listing could not be read, so a viewer or review check is still owed before submission.
- Scale: one model call per show for aliasing, zero per line. 10 shows a week is trivial on a free tier.

AI tools used, and one place they got it wrong

- Claude Code for parsing and counting across the 50 scripts, and for drafting this index.
- Wrong place: the first count reported 1545 "dialogue lines"; 114 of those were SOUND FX rows the parser treated as a speaker. Real dialogue is 1431. Same class of trap the resolver must guard against.